

Who Wins the World Cup?

A Monte Carlo simulation of the 48-team tournament, driven by World Football Elo ratings and xG-adjusted match outcomes.

TITLE FAVOURITE

Spain
21.7% to win

CLOSEST CHALLENGER

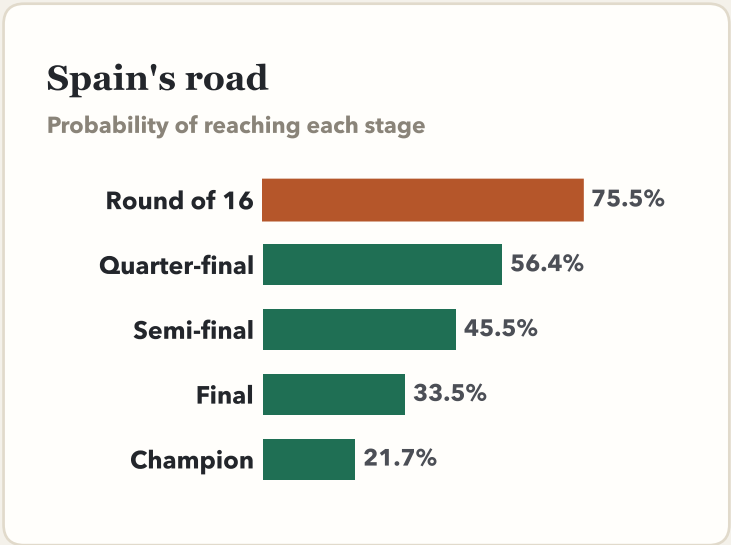
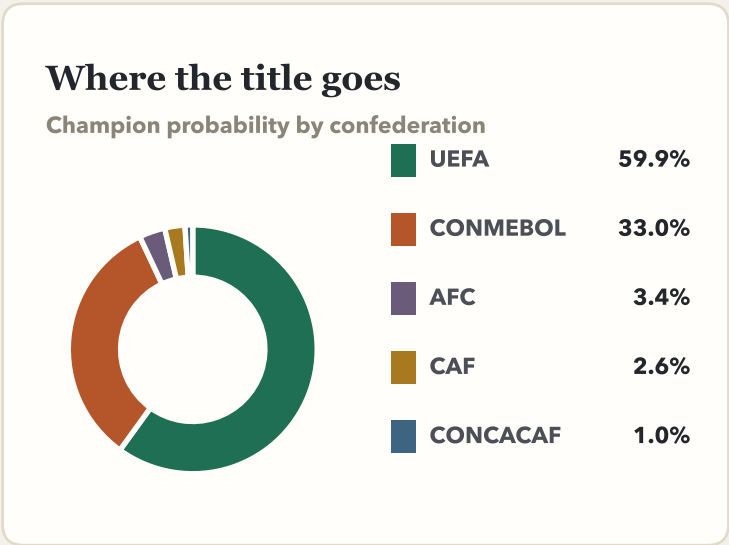
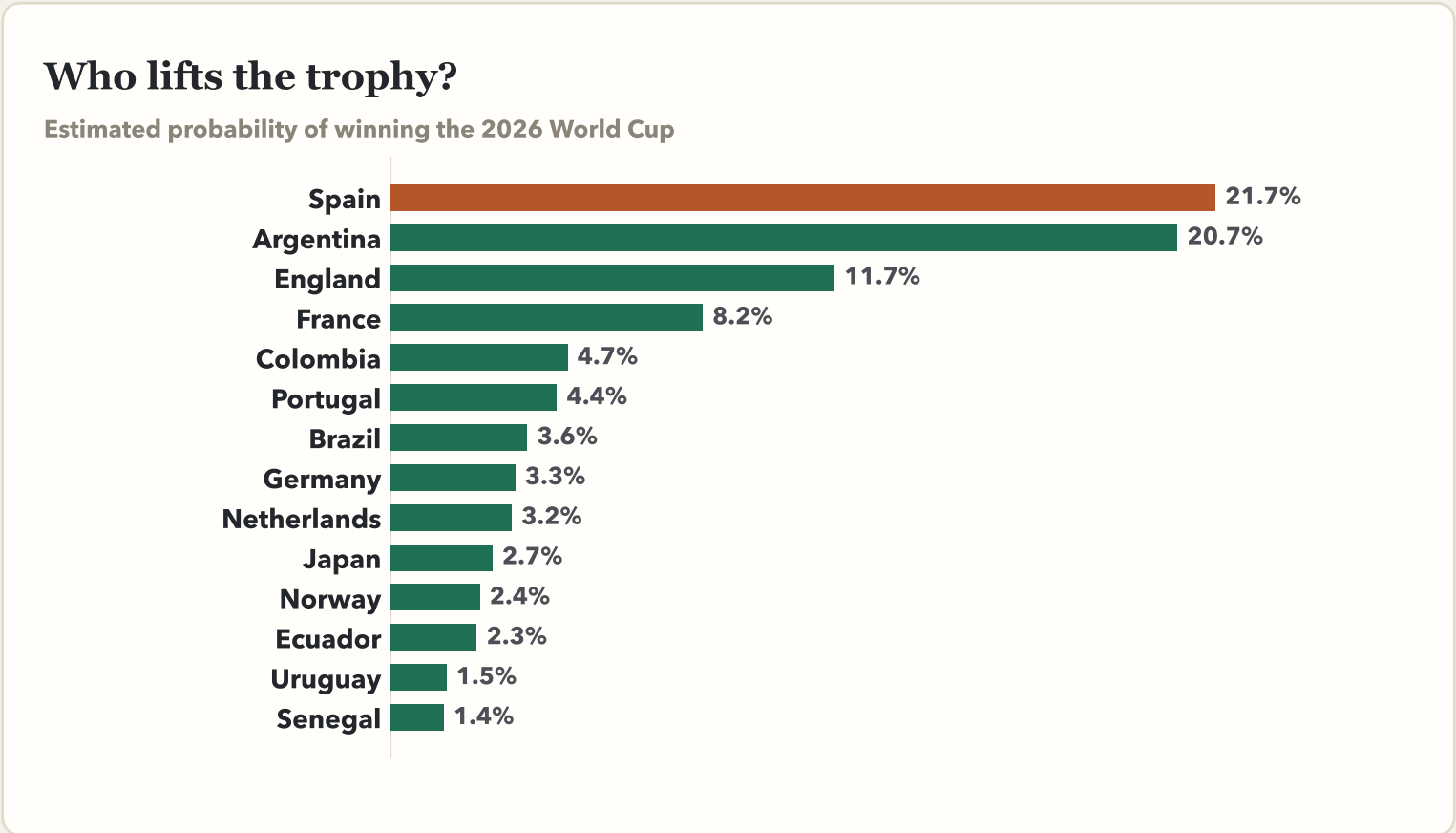
Argentina
20.7% to win

FIELD

48 teams
12 groups of four

SIMULATIONS

10,000
as of June 9, 2026



The Path Through the Bracket

Each team's chance of surviving to the round of 16, quarter-finals, semi-finals, final and title.

How far each team is likely to go

Probability of reaching each stage. Darker means more likely.

	Round of 16	Quarter	Semi	Final	Win
1 Spain	76%	56%	46%	33%	22%
2 Argentina	70%	59%	44%	31%	21%
3 England	72%	52%	35%	20%	12%
4 France	70%	47%	30%	16%	8.2%
5 Colombia	60%	36%	19%	10.0%	4.7%
6 Portugal	60%	35%	19%	9.7%	4.4%
7 Brazil	59%	35%	19%	8.5%	3.6%
8 Germany	62%	33%	18%	7.6%	3.3%
9 Netherlands	55%	34%	17%	7.5%	3.2%
10 Japan	51%	31%	15%	6.8%	2.7%
11 Norway	53%	28%	14%	5.7%	2.4%
12 Ecuador	56%	28%	14%	6.0%	2.3%
13 Uruguay	38%	21%	11%	4.4%	1.5%
14 Senegal	45%	22%	9.9%	4.0%	1.4%

Group favourites

Two most likely sides to advance from each group.

Group A Mexico 47% to reach the round of 16 South Korea 39%	Group B Switzerland 60% to reach the round of 16 Canada 48%	Group C Brazil 59% to reach the round of 16 Morocco 43%	Group D Turkey 45% to reach the round of 16 Paraguay 34%
Group E Germany 62% to reach the round of 16 Ecuador 56%	Group F Netherlands 55% to reach the round of 16 Japan 51%	Group G Belgium 56% to reach the round of 16 Iran 25%	Group H Spain 76% to reach the round of 16 Uruguay 38%
Group I France 70% to reach the round of 16 Norway 53%	Group J Argentina 70% to reach the round of 16 Austria 26%	Group K Colombia 60% to reach the round of 16 Portugal 60%	Group L England 72% to reach the round of 16 Croatia 44%

Does the Model Actually Work?

Backtests replay each past tournament from its pre-tournament ratings and score the forecast.

Tested on the last World Cups

Re-running the model with pre-tournament ratings only – no hindsight.

WORLD CUP	ACTUAL CHAMPION	MODEL'S PRE-TOURNAMENT ODDS	RANK
2014	Germany	18.1%	#3
2018	France	5.7%	#5
2022	Argentina	21.8%	#2

Why it holds up

#3.3

average pre-tournament rank
the model gave the eventual winner

3/3

champions the model placed
inside its top five favourites

0.038

mean calibration error
(predicted vs. observed rates)